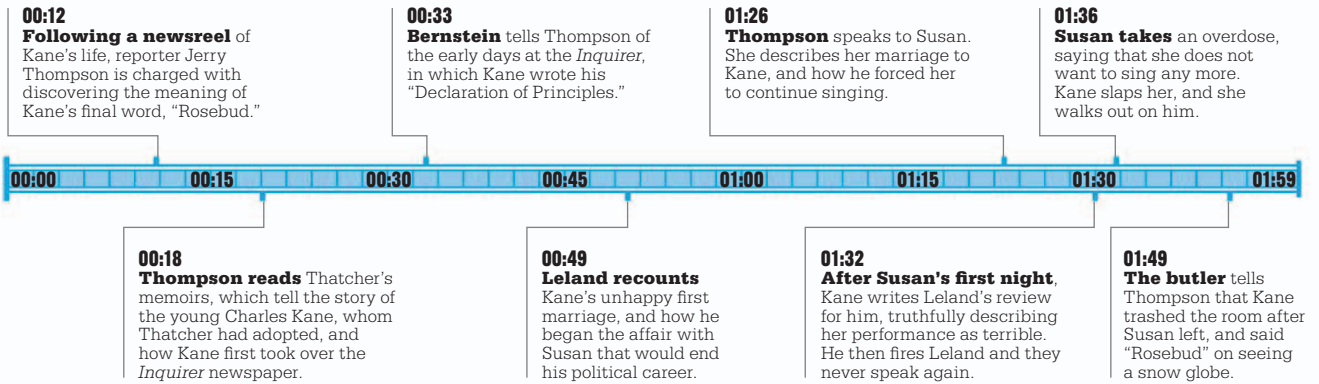


What else to watch: *The Magnificent Ambersons* (1942) ■ *The Lady from Shanghai* (1947) ■ *The Third Man* (1949, pp.100–03) ■ *Touch of Evil* (1958, p.333) ■ *The Trial* (1962) ■ *Me and Orson Welles* (2008)

Minute by minute



Hitler (cutting to a shot of Kane declaring, pompously, "You can take my word for it, there will be no war"). Next come the women in his life, and how an illicit affair cut short his political career. The audience is shown his rise, fall, and withdrawal from public life.

The riddle of Rosebud

When the newsreel ends, its producer isn't satisfied: he wants to know who Charles Foster Kane was, not what he did, and sends reporter Jerry Thompson (William Alland) to discover the meaning of the word Kane uttered with his last breath: "Rosebud." At this point, *Citizen Kane* essentially becomes two movies. The framework is Kane's life as recounted by his friends and enemies, as Thompson squares up to this extraordinary riddle wrapped in a larger-than-life enigma. But Welles also slyly offers the audience other scenes from Kane's life in flashback, a »

In happier days, Kane and Leland stand surrounded by copies of the *Inquirer*. Kane intends to use the paper to campaign for ordinary folk, a pledge that Leland will later throw back at him.

